



UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED MEETS EMIR OF QATAR

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan held talks in Abu Dhabi on Saturday with Sheikh Tamim Bin Hamad Al Thani, Emir of Qatar. The meeting, which took place during the Qatari Emir's fraternal visit to the UAE, saw the leaders discuss the close relations between their countries and ways to strengthen cooperation to support shared development priorities.

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Dubai pushes trackless tram plan, more bus and taxi lanes

PROJECTS TO IMPROVE COMMUTING, REDUCE CONGESTION

DUBAI

BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Managing Editor

Dubai is stepping up its transport infrastructure with ambitious expansion projects designed to make commuting faster, safer, and more sustainable.

Central to this drive is the planned trackless tram system, an autonomous, electric-powered transit solution that uses virtual tracks guided by cameras detecting road markings. Offering lower costs and faster implementation than conventional trams, the system is set to operate across eight key locations.

Alongside this, the Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) is extending dedicated bus and taxi lanes, adding six new corridors totalling 13km to increase the overall network to 20km. These lanes are expected to reduce bus journey times by 41 per cent, improve on-time performance by 42 per cent, and increase ridership by 10 per cent, providing commuters with a reliable alternative to private cars.

Mattar Al Tayer, Director General and Chairman of the Board of

KEY FEATURES

- Each tram will have three carriages, accommodating up to 300 passengers.
- It will reach a top speed of 70km/h, with an operational speed ranging from 25 to 60km/h.
- A single charge will enable the tram to cover a distance of up to 100km.

—A. A.

Executive Directors of RTA, said: "These projects form part of our vision to position public transport as the first choice for mobility in Dubai. By enhancing service quality, expanding coverage, and integrating multiple modes, we are creating a flexible, sustainable, and efficient system that supports the city's growth and improves quality of life for residents and visitors."

With the trackless tram, new dedicated lanes, and ongoing network enhancements, Dubai is moving closer to a seamless, high-capacity, and future-ready transport ecosystem.

The next-generation tram, which operates without fixed

tracks, uses optical navigation, GPS, and LiDAR technologies to follow virtual routes with remarkable precision. Powered by AI, the system detects obstacles and adjusts its path in real time, offering a flexible, sustainable, and cost-efficient alternative to traditional rail systems.

New dimension

Dubai's trackless tram will add a new dimension to the emirate's advanced public transport system, which already includes the Dubai Metro and the Dubai Tram, the first tram system outside Europe powered by a ground-based electric supply.

Mattar Al Tayer said the trackless tram embodies Dubai's ambition to lead the world in smart, sustainable public transport.

According to RTA, the trackless tram would be deployed at eight locations across Dubai. This self-driving tram system operates on virtual tracks, guided by cameras that follow painted lines on dedicated lanes. Powered by electricity, it offers a more sustainable alternative with lower costs and quicker construction timelines compared to traditional trams.

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